

Career Vision Overview

You are leveraging your dual background in **Electronics & Biomedical Engineering** and **Software Development/AI** to target high-impact, remote or hybrid roles in:

- Developer Experience / Tooling Engineer
- Creative Technologist / Prototyper
- Applied AI / Research Tools Developer
- Automation / Test Engineering

Core Goal: Merge hands-on technical engineering expertise with modern software development and AI-powered tool creation, using **StoryStacker** as a flagship portfolio project.

Target Salary: \$80K+

Starting Certifications

1. PCAP – Python Certified Associate Programmer

- a. Duration: ~40-50 hrs prep
- b. Cost: ~\$295
- c. Description: Validates intermediate Python programming skills, including object-oriented programming, functions, and best practices. Highly valued in AI, automation, and tooling roles.

2. AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

- a. Duration: ~20 hrs prep
- b. Cost: ~\$100
- c. Description: Foundational AWS certification covering core cloud concepts, services, pricing, and security. Demonstrates cloud literacy without requiring deep specialization.

3. Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)

- a. Duration: ~10-15 hrs prep
- b. Cost: Often free with vouchers/events
- c. Description: Introduces basic Azure concepts, services, pricing, and governance. Useful for multi-cloud positioning.

4. Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900)

- a. Duration: ~10-15 hrs prep

- b. Cost: Often free with vouchers/events
- c. Description: Covers fundamental AI and machine learning concepts in the Azure ecosystem. Perfect for validating AI knowledge in a business context.

Additional Fast-Track Certifications

5. GitHub Foundations Certification

- a. Duration: ~5-8 hrs prep
- b. Cost: Free
- c. Description: Demonstrates understanding of GitHub repositories, version control, branching, and collaboration workflows.

6. Certified Entry-Level Python Programmer (PCEP)

- a. Duration: ~20 hrs prep
- b. Cost: ~\$59
- c. Description: Entry-level Python certification covering syntax, data types, control structures, and basic coding logic. Serves as a stepping stone to PCAP.

7. Google Cloud Digital Leader Certification

- a. Duration: ~20 hrs prep
- b. Cost: ~\$99
- c. Description: Foundational Google Cloud certification focusing on cloud solutions, digital transformation, and security.

8. Automation Anywhere Certified Essentials RPA Professional

- a. Duration: ~10 hrs prep
- b. Cost: Free
- c. Description: Introduces Robotic Process Automation concepts and practical skills for automating repetitive tasks.

9. Prompt Engineering for ChatGPT (DeepLearning.AI + OpenAI)

- a. Duration: ~6-8 hrs
- b. Cost: Free (Coursera)
- c. Description: Teaches effective prompt design for large language models, with a focus on OpenAI's ChatGPT. Highly relevant for AI tool creation.

10. IBM AI Engineering Professional Certificate

- a. Duration: ~30-40 hrs (fast-track audit)
- b. Cost: Free to audit / \$49 per month for verified track
- c. Description: Covers machine learning, deep learning, and AI application development using IBM tools and open-source frameworks.

Notes & Resources

- Many Microsoft and cloud certifications offer **free vouchers** if you attend short online events.
- Updating StoryStacker on GitHub with a professional README will enhance your credibility when combined with these certifications.
- This combination of **AI fundamentals, cloud expertise, Python mastery, and automation skills** positions you strongly for your target roles.